Design Explanation

CS381 — Web Application Development | Personal Academic Portfolio

Project Overview

A three-page personal academic portfolio website built entirely with semantic HTML5 and custom CSS3 — no frameworks, no templates, no generators. The design uses a dark theme with a warm orange accent palette to create a modern, professional developer aesthetic.

Page Structure

Page	File	Content
Home	index.html	Hero section, About Me, Technical Skills, Hobbies, Learning Goals
Profile	profile.html	Profile card, CV — Education, Academic Projects, Certifications
Contact	contact.html	Contact information and contact form

Color Scheme & Typography

Element	Value	Purpose
Primary Accent	#f97316 (Orange)	Headings, links, borders, highlights
Background	#0a0a0f (Near Black)	Page background
Surface	#12121a	Cards and navigation background
Body Text	#e8e8f0 (Off White)	Main readable text
Display Font	Playfair Display (serif)	Section headings — editorial, refined feel
Body Font	DM Sans (sans-serif)	Body text — clean and readable
Mono Font	JetBrains Mono	Student ID, dates, code-style labels

Layout — CSS Grid & Flexbox

Technique	Where Used
CSS Grid	Hero (text + photo, 2-col), CV (sidebar 1fr + main 2fr), Hobbies (3-col), Contact (2-col)
Flexbox	Navbar, CTA buttons, contact info items, profile meta tags, tag lists

Responsive Design (Mobile-First)

CSS is written mobile-first — base styles target small screens, then media queries enhance for larger screens.

Breakpoint	Changes Applied
max-width: 900px	Hero, CV, and contact grids collapse to single column. Hobbies becomes 2-column.
max-width: 600px	Navigation collapses to hamburger. Hobbies and form rows become single-column.

Accessibility

- Skip-to-content link at top of every page for keyboard users
- All images have descriptive alt attributes
- Semantic HTML5 elements: nav, main, section, article, aside, footer
- ARIA roles and labels throughout (role, aria-label, aria-current, aria-expanded)
- Skill bars use role='progressbar' with aria-valuenow, aria-valuemin, aria-valuemax
- All form inputs linked to labels via matching for/id attributes
- focus-visible outline ensures visible keyboard focus on all interactive elements